

Evgenii Kuzakov

Senior / Team Lead DevOps Engineer

Building production-ready Kubernetes platforms from scratch — cluster to app delivery in 15–30 min via GitOps & IaC

7 yrs DevOps · 15+ yrs Engineering · English B2 · Remote
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Email: eugeny.kuzakov@gmail.com · Telegram: [@korkin25](https://t.me/korkin25) ·
LinkedIn: [eugenykuzakov](#)
WhatsApp: [+7-915-495-8170](https://wa.me/9154958170)

Professional Summary

- **Platform from zero to production in minutes:** Built end-to-end SDLC platforms from scratch — Terraform provisions Talos clusters, FluxCD reconciles the platform, Argo CD delivers apps — cutting new environment provisioning from days to 15–30 minutes.
- **Multi-cloud Kubernetes at scale:** Designed and operated Kubernetes across 4 providers (DigitalOcean, vSphere, bare metal, Yandex MKS), managing 7+ production clusters and serving 5+ development teams with a unified GitOps-first delivery model.
- **Measurable performance gains:** Achieved 10x Vault data-access speedup via Redis caching, deployed a 300k msg/s logging platform on OpenSearch, and eliminated manual operations with 100% IaC/GitOps automation.

Core Skills

Kubernetes & GitOps: Talos, FluxCD, Argo CD, Argo Rollouts, Helm, Helmfile, Kustomize, Cilium, Gateway API

IaC & Automation: Terraform, Terramate, Ansible, SaltStack, Packer

CI/CD: GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Docker BuildKit, Kaniko

Security & Secrets: HashiCorp Vault, External Secrets, Keycloak, Authentik

Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, ELK/OpenSearch, Fluent Bit

Cloud: Yandex Cloud (primary) · AWS · GCP · DigitalOcean

Employment

DevOps Engineer — NDA (Sep 2025 - Present)

- Built a full SDLC platform from scratch with a zero-manual-operations model — 100% IaC and GitOps, reducing new production-ready cluster provisioning from days to **15-30 minutes**.
- Designed Talos-based Kubernetes platforms across DigitalOcean, vSphere, and bare-metal servers (kexec-based flows), with FluxCD for platform reconciliation and Argo CD for application delivery.
- Implemented progressive delivery with Argo Rollouts and migrated traffic management from Ingress controllers to Gateway API with Cilium — improving rollout safety and routing flexibility.
- Built the end-to-end bootstrap pipeline: Terraform provisions Talos clusters, installs Flux/flux-sync, and post-bootstrap automation populates Vault credentials for all dependent services.
- Operated core platform services: MinIO Operator, CloudNativePG, Vault, External Secrets, KubeVirt, vLLM, GPU Operator, NVIDIA Device Plugin, Node Feature Discovery.
- Integrated Authentik with GitLab and GitHub as IdPs — delivered SSO across all platform services.

Senior DevOps Engineer — HRS International (Jul 2024 - Aug 2025)

- Built a cloud-agnostic platform layout across 3 providers (Yandex, AWS, GCP) — decoupled infra code from config to enable independent release cycles and cut cross-team deployment conflicts.
- Standardized GitOps-first delivery across dev, test, prod, and client-tenant environments through merge-request-driven change management.
- Authored reusable Terraform modules and Terramate stacks, managed drift detection and reconciliation — all infrastructure changes went through Git, zero manual modifications.
- Operated production-grade Yandex MKS clusters and governed cloud services: VPC, DNS, NLB/ALB, Managed PostgreSQL, Object Storage, IAM, KMS.
- Enforced Pod Security Standards, zero-trust network policies, and Vault-based secrets management with automated rotation.

R&D Senior DevOps Engineer — SoftSwiss (Dec 2022 - Aug 2023)

- Reworked SaltStack-Vault integration (Python): achieved **2x** operation speed improvement and **10x** data-access speedup via Redis caching, multi-endpoint access, and Enhanced Key support.
- Researched and implemented a company-wide IAM/SSO model with Keycloak as the central identity source.
- Built a SaltStack Users formula covering user/group management, SSH access, 2FA, and `authorized_keys`.

Head of DevOps — Latoken (Sep 2022 - Oct 2022) · Contract/Audit

- Conducted a full DevOps infrastructure audit, defined the roadmap, and deployed a **~300k msg/s** logging platform on 5 OpenSearch nodes + 2 Logstash + 2 HAProxy VMs.
- Contributed improvements to the OpenSearch community Ansible playbook: Vagrant-based testing, reduced root requirements, optional UFW/Logstash integration, and Fluent Bit examples.

Senior DevOps — Satel Pro (Oct 2019 - Aug 2022)

- Led DevOps delivery across 5+ development teams, managing 2 dev/test and 5 production Kubernetes clusters.
 - Built a fully automated pipeline: Packer images → Terraform/Cloud-init VMs → Kubernetes install → Helmfile services → monitoring & logging — eliminating manual provisioning steps.
 - Reworked rollout model with GitLab CI + Helm; implemented release-driven flows (dev → RC → prod) with Vault-secured secrets.
 - Optimized Docker builds (multistage, BuildKit, distributed caching, lazy loading) and hardened workloads with requests/limits, probes, PDBs, and read-only filesystems.
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Open Projects and Publications

- **Open CI/CD** — production-grade GitLab CI/CD templates reused across multiple projects without modification. Covers Docker BuildKit builds, Helm deployments (ArgoCD/FluxCD/Swarm), SAST, cosign signing, changelogs, and change detection to skip unnecessary jobs.
- **Kubernetes Resource Calculator** — CLI tool for calculating Kubernetes resource requests and limits.
- **Kubernetes Limits Calc Article** — published on Habr.

- **25devops** — DevOps news channel covering Kubernetes, Docker, and DevSecOps.

Full Technology Reference

Area	Stack
Kubernetes & OS	Talos, k0s, Containerd, Cilium, Calico, Gateway API
GitOps & Delivery	FluxCD, Argo CD, Argo Rollouts, Helm, Helmfile, Kustomize
IaC & Config Mgmt	Terraform, Terramate, Ansible, SaltStack, Packer
CI/CD & Builds	GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Docker BuildKit, Kaniko
Security & IAM	HashiCorp Vault, External Secrets, Keycloak, Authentik
Observability	Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, ELK/OpenSearch, Logstash, Fluent Bit, Fluentd
Data & Storage	CloudNativePG, Stolon, PoWA, Liquibase, MinIO, Nexus, Harbor
Virtualization	VMware vSphere, KubeVirt, VirtualBox
GPU / AI	vLLM, GPU Operator, NVIDIA Device Plugin, Node Feature Discovery
Languages	Bash, Python

Cloud Providers

Provider	Services
Yandex Cloud	IAM, Compute Cloud, VPC, DNS, NLB, ALB, Managed PostgreSQL, Managed Redis, Cloud Logging, Lockbox, Object Storage
AWS	IAM, EC2, EKS, ELB, S3, RDS, Route 53, ACM
GCP	IAM, Compute Engine, Kubernetes Engine, Cloud Load Balancing, GCS, Cloud

Provider	Services
DigitalOcean	SQL, Cloud DNS, Certificate Manager
	Droplets, Networking, Load Balancers, Managed Kubernetes

Education

Omsk State Technical University — “Metrology and Device Manufacturing” faculty

Availability

Remote · Full-time (preferred) · Part-time · Consulting

Prior Experience

- **IBS Expertise** — Systems Architect / Chief Project Engineer (Oct 2016 – Aug 2019): Designed technical architectures and led pre-sales for large-scale government and enterprise projects.
- **Technoserv** — Systems Architect / Chief Project Engineer (Jun 2014 – Aug 2016): Developed complex infrastructure architectures and led major delivery initiatives, including the Secure City program.
- **Open Technologies Ltd.** — Systems Architect / Chief Technical Project Manager (Aug 2012 – Mar 2014): Managed vendor portfolio development and technical pre-sales for enterprise infrastructure.
- **AMT Group** — Head of Data Processing Centers / Product Manager (Jul 2008 – Jul 2012): Led business development of enterprise infrastructure platforms and strategic vendor partnerships.
- **Open Technologies Ltd.** — Senior Systems Engineer (Feb 2001 – Jun 2008): Delivered HA, storage, SAN, clustering, and DR solutions for large data center projects.
- **Earlier roles** (1994–2000): Systems/Network Administrator at International Trading Bank, Plusinfo, and Laboratory 321 Ltd.